NexCort iQ™

Intelligence at the Speed of Response™

THE NEXCORT iQ SIGNAL™

Your Monthly Pulse on Public Safety Intelligence

VOL. 1 | NO. 2

DECEMBER 2026

911 During the Holidays

Preparing for higher call volumes, unique seasonal risks, and community safety throughout the holiday season.

INSIDE THIS EDITION

- Managing seasonal call volume increases
- Public safety at holiday events and venues
- Weather and winter emergency readiness
- Best practices for a safer holiday season

PSAP / 911 | CITY SERVICES | CAMPUS | VENUE | TRANSIT | WEATHER READINESS

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DECEMBER 2026 · VOLUME 1 · ISSUE 2

911 DURING THE HOLIDAYS

Surge, staffing, and system resilience when it matters most

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- 14-Day Holiday Pilot Checklist + January 2027 Pilot CTA

PSAP / 911 | CITY SERVICES | CAMPUS | VENUE | TRANSIT | WEATHER

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FROM THE FOUNDER

A Message to Every Public Safety Professional This Season

December in emergency communications is unlike any other month. While the rest of the world slows down, your workload accelerates — and you do it with less staff, higher stakes, and the quiet expectation that nothing will go wrong on Christmas Eve.

This issue is dedicated to you — the dispatchers, supervisors, and emergency communications professionals who don't get to close early. You are the reason families get help when they need it most. That work is not invisible to us.

We built NexCort iQ because the people who protect others deserve better tools — not workarounds, not more tabs, not another system that breaks at 02:00 on a holiday weekend. Our platform is designed to hold under pressure, because that's exactly when you need it. From all of us at Rapid Cortex: thank you for what you do, and stay safe this season.

— Dr. Jeffrey W. Coleman Jr., Founder & CEO, Apps on Demand LLC / NexCort iQ

> ***"You are the reason families get help when they need it most. That work is not invisible to us."***

THE HOLIDAY 911 SURGE

Beyond Volume: What the Call Mix Actually Looks Like

Every center knows December brings more calls. What's less discussed is how that volume changes in *character* — and why that matters for how you staff, dispatch, and configure your platforms.

Non-emergency and welfare check calls rise sharply. "Is my elderly mother okay?" spikes when traveling families realize they haven't heard from a relative. Wellness check requests on Christmas morning and New Year's Day are among the highest of the year — consuming officer time that matters everywhere else in the queue.

Mental health and behavioral crisis calls increase in parallel. The combination of alcohol, family conflict, financial stress, and isolation drives up behavioral dispatches across all agency types. Many of these callers are known to the system but arrive through 911 because alternate pathways — crisis lines, mobile teams — are also understaffed over the holidays.

Traffic incidents spike on specific nights. DUI-related crashes cluster on Christmas Eve, Christmas night, and New Year's Eve. Weather-related collisions compound in northern jurisdictions. The post-10:00 PM window on December 31 is consistently the highest-volume single hour in many PSAPs' annual data. Plan for it explicitly — it is not a surprise.

LANGUAGE ACCESS

LEP Call Spikes: When Families Travel Home for the Holidays

The holiday travel surge brings a parallel operational challenge: Limited English Proficiency (LEP) call rates increase when visiting family members become witnesses, callers, or subjects of emergency incidents. Someone who calls 911 in a city they're visiting may not speak the primary language of that PSAP — and may never have interacted with 911 before.

PSAPs with established language line protocols handle this well. Those without consistent interpreter access face delays that compound in already-surging queues. NexCort iQ's live transcript and language detection module flags LEP indicators in real-time, allowing supervisors to route interpreter access before the call bogs down and before the caller disconnects out of frustration.

THE 02:00 PROBLEM

Supervisor Coverage When OT Is Thin

Here is a scenario that plays out somewhere every December: it's 02:17 on Christmas morning. The floor is running four positions with two overtime dispatchers. The on-duty supervisor stepped away. A multi-vehicle accident with reported entrapment comes in simultaneously with an unresponsive caller.

Who is watching the floor? Not just physically present — but actively monitoring queue depth, call handling times, unit availability, and stress indicators across positions?

Supervisory visibility degrades exactly when it matters most. Holiday schedules thin command layers, while incident complexity increases. NexCort iQ's supervisor dashboard provides a single-screen view of active calls, unit disposition, queue depth, and position performance — readable in three seconds while handling other responsibilities. One person can hold the floor picture when staffing makes full supervisor presence impossible.

PLATFORM SPOTLIGHT

NexCort iQ Under Peak Load: Four Things That Don't Break

CAPABILITY	WHAT IT DOES UNDER LOAD	WHY IT MATTERS DEC 31
Live Transcript	Streams in real-time regardless of concurrent call count; no queuing or delay at peak volume	Dispatchers retain full call context even when the queue is stacked
Role Isolation	Venue and campus data never routes into PSAP dashboards; vertical lanes stay operationally independent	NYE venue surge does not pollute PSAP resource views or unit tables
Fail-Closed CAD Bridge	If the NexCort iQ ↔ CAD connection drops, no phantom writes or surprise unit changes appear in CAD	Protects data integrity when holiday staffing delays reconnection
Supervisor Dashboard	Single-screen queue depth, unit disposition, position load — sub-3-second situational read	Essential when command layers are thin at 02:00 AM

VERTICAL DEEP DIVE

Four Environments. One System. Zero Holiday Downtime.

PSAP / 911 — MANAGING PEAK CALL VOLUME

- Non-emergency and welfare check mix rises sharply — expect "is my relative OK?" calls to peak Christmas morning and New Year's Day
- LEP call rates increase with holiday travel; ensure language line access is documented and accessible at every dispatch position
- Mental health and behavioral crisis calls rise in tandem with alcohol incidents — coordinate with mobile crisis teams before December 24
- Post-10:00 PM December 31 is statistically the highest-volume single hour in many PSAPs' annual data; build your staffing model around it
- Supervisor dashboard provides real-time queue visibility when OT staff is thinly spread across a reduced floor

CAMPUS — EMPTY QUADS, SKELETON STAFF

- Winter break clears residential students but creates a different problem: reduced campus public safety coverage monitoring depopulated buildings
- Break-in and trespass incidents on empty campuses are common; blue-light and silent report channels must route correctly when patrol is minimal
- "Who gets notified?" becomes critical — if the primary officer is handling mutual aid, who is the escalation contact for a silent alarm trigger at 03:00 AM?
- Campus-to-host-PSAP handoff protocols should be tested before break, not discovered during an incident
- NexCort iQ campus vertical isolates routing to defined on-call contacts and escalation paths independent of PSAP load

TRANSIT — LAST TRAIN, LATE PLATFORM

- Late-night holiday service concentrates risk: last trains carry high passenger loads, often impaired, with minimal staffing on platforms
- Medical incidents on platforms on December 31 require immediate host PSAP coordination — transit PD and municipal units must share the operational picture
- Weather delays compound platform crowding; a crowd-crush or medical cascade on a delayed NYE platform is a mass-casualty precursor, not an anomaly
- Confirm host PSAP liaisons and direct radio channels before New Year's weekend — not the morning of
- NexCort iQ transit vertical syncs incident data with host PSAP table in real-time, enabling joint resource deployment without duplicate dispatches

VENUE — NYE EGRESS AND MEDICAL RESPONSE

- Record attendance figures mean record egress complexity — a staggered midnight exit with impaired pedestrians is an active incident management scenario
- Medical incidents spike between 11:30 PM and 01:30 AM — medical staging, AED locations, and triage flow must be pre-planned and confirmed with host PSAP EMS
- Crowd-related incidents (falls, crush, altercations) in parking structures and exit corridors are routinely undercounted in after-action reports
- Staff fatigue peaks at the end of a 10-hour event shift — plan supervisor rotation to maintain incident command coherence through midnight
- NexCort iQ venue vertical provides live occupancy and incident tracking with direct CAD bridge to municipal EMS and police units

FUNDING FOCUS

Year-End Deadlines & FY2027 Planning: Apply vs. Plan

December is not just busy operationally — it is the most consequential month for emergency communications technology funding. The distinction between grants to apply for now versus grants to begin planning for matters enormously. Directors who miss the apply window lose a full year.

FUNDING SOURCE	TIMELINE	ACTION	WHAT IT FUNDS
State 911 Board / State Technology Program	Many states close FY Q2 (Dec–Jan) allocation windows in December. Check your state 911 board website this week.	APPLY NOW	NG911 infrastructure, PSAP technology upgrades, training platforms, interoperability systems
Year-End Capital / Local Budget Carryover	Unspent FY2026 capital allocations must often be obligated by December 31. Contact your budget office immediately.	APPLY NOW	Any approved technology line item — platform licenses, integrations, hardware, professional services
BRIC — FY2027 (FEMA)	FEMA BRIC FY2027 application window typically opens Q1 2027. Begin project documentation and narrative now.	PLAN NOW	Communications infrastructure, interoperability, resilience systems; up to $2M per project
COPS Technology Program (DOJ)	DOJ COPS Technology grants for law enforcement technology. FY2027 Notice of Funding typically January–March 2027.	PLAN NOW	LE technology, analytical tools, dispatch support and decision systems

14-DAY HOLIDAY PILOT CHECKLIST

What to Measure During Peak: A Framework for Pilot Agencies

If your agency is running or evaluating NexCort iQ during the December–January peak period, fourteen days of holiday-period data provides one of the most stress-tested baselines available. These are the operational metrics that matter most.

METRIC	WHAT TO CAPTURE	TARGET OUTCOME
Call Handling Time	Average time-to-answer and time-to-dispatch by shift; compare holiday vs. pre-holiday baseline	Identify where NexCort iQ pre-arrival intelligence reduces Q&A; time
Supervisor Intervention Rate	How many times did a supervisor intervene in a call or reassign a unit vs. baseline periods	Dashboard reduces reactive corrections; track the before/after delta
LEP Call Resolution Time	Time from LEP flag to interpreter connect; track interpreter activation rate per shift	Real-time language detection should reduce interpreter delay
CAD Bridge Uptime	Log any CAD sync events, reconnects, or fail-closed activations during the 14-day window	Zero phantom writes or data corruption events expected
Dispatcher Fatigue Indicators	Track overtime hours, positions running single-dispatch, and supervisor-noted stress events	Provides baseline for staffing model and wellness analysis post-holiday

COMPANY UPDATES

Rapid Cortex | NexCort iQ — November–December 2026

Pilot Expansion

Following production pilots in Q3–Q4 2026, we are onboarding three new agency partners in Q1 2027 across PSAP, campus, and venue verticals. All pilots include structured 60-day evaluation periods with documented performance metrics.

NG911 Certification Progress

Our NG911 integration layer has completed initial interoperability testing against i3 standards. Full certification documentation is targeted for Q1 2027, supporting deployment at NG911-capable PSAPs and ECCs across all supported verticals.

CAD Integration Roadmap

Integration pathways are confirmed with three additional CAD vendors beyond our initial supported list. Integration timelines and documentation are available to agencies under pilot or procurement evaluation.

Pre-Arrival iQ Module

Our Pre-Arrival iQ module — real-time medical and tactical guidance at the point of dispatch — enters structured pilot phase in January 2027. Issue 3 (January) will include a full deep dive on Pre-Arrival iQ capabilities, deployment requirements, and pilot data.

START YOUR 60-DAY PILOT — JANUARY 2027

Post-holiday is the right moment to evaluate. Your January traffic baseline provides ideal comparison data against the peak you just navigated. NexCort iQ pilots are structured, measured, and free for qualifying agencies.

Contact: pilots@rapidcortex.com | rapidcortex.com/pilot

NEXT ISSUE — JANUARY 2027

Vol. 1, No. 3: Pre-Arrival iQ — Intelligence at the Point of Dispatch. A deep dive into our Pre-Arrival iQ module: how real-time medical guidance, structural intelligence, and incident classification deliver decision support in the seconds between call answer and unit arrival. Pilot data, case examples, and integration architecture included.

SHARE THIS ISSUE

Three ready-to-post points for LinkedIn or your internal channels:

• “Holiday 911 surge isn’t just volume — it’s call mix, LEP spikes, welfare checks, and 02:00 AM supervisor coverage. NexCort iQ is built for exactly that moment.” → rapidcortex.com/newsletter/vol1-no2
• “Empty campuses during winter break create real security gaps. Blue-light and silent report channels need to route correctly when PS staff is minimal.” → rapidcortex.com/newsletter/vol1-no2
• “NYE venue egress and medical staging is an active incident management scenario. Pre-planned, not improvised.” → rapidcortex.com/newsletter/vol1-no2